RSS Digest
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1. Quoting Nilay Patel
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-11-06T17:13:12+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Nov/6/nilay-patel/
The products aren’t good enough to sell people on the costs. You cannot tell people that you have to listen to the whine of a data center in their backyard for AI overviews and some of the most hilarious deep fake slop in history. It’s not worth it. It just isn’t worth it to anyone.
And agents aren’t real and they might not be being used the way that anyone wants them to yet. All these companies are spending more than they’re making on these products. Refrigerators holding blood storage in Europe are being hacked. The costs are too high. The benefits are not real. And if you connect that to corruption, you’re like, in order to impose these costs on me, these CEOs are in the White House shaking Trump’s hand, renaming it to the Gulf of America, paying for this ballroom that we don’t want. It’s obvious crypto-corruption, and it’s still slop. The AI industry will not get out of it until they make better products . Until everyone can see without needing to be convinced, without needing an ad campaign, without any of this stuff that just using these products makes your life better. ? Nilay Patel , The Vergecast: Big Tech lost big in the 2026 election Tags: nilay-patel , slop , ai , gene...

2. Working with designers
Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Sat, 07 Nov 2026 00:00:00 GMT
Link: https://seangoedecke.com/working-with-designers/
I love working with designers, in part because (unlike managers and product managers) they?re culturally different from engineers. However, having more than one designer on a team is asking for trouble, and I have complicated negative thoughts about design systems. Design is a strange role Designers demonstrate their value immediately. While working on some feature, I?ll typically put together some placeholder UI that I?m reasonably happy with. I then show it to a designer, who strokes their chin and says ?hmm, I have some ideas here?. They then go away and produce a mockup UI that is not just clearly better, but better in ways I could not have imagined. There aren?t any other roles at a tech company where you can see the value at a glance. Designers are an unusual role in other ways, too. Engineering managers, product managers, and engineers all come from broadly the same stock: technical, detail-oriented planners. We are people of the spreadsheet. In fact, many managers and product managers were once engineers: it?s a natural transition. Not so for designers. I?m sure they exist, but I?ve never met any designers who started out as engineers. Because of this, designers are cultur...

3. Libghostty 1.0
Source: Mitchell Hashimoto | Published: Fri, 06 Nov 2026 00:00:00 GMT
Link: https://mitchellh.com/writing/libghostty-1-0
(No summary)

4. Writing English is Solved
Source: Software and Tech stories from an Insider - iDiallo.com | Published: Fri, 06 Nov 2026 08:00:00 GMT
Link: https://idiallo.com/byte-size/english-is-solved
Maybe you still struggle to write in Pulaar, or in your rinky-dink language. But here in the AI-connected, English-speaking world, we don’t need to write anymore. In fact, I don’t remember the last time I wrote English. I have one master agent that I talk to and tell what I need to get done. It breaks down the tasks and serves them to spawned agents that get the work done. I spend $3,000 a month on tokens. I use them mostly for: Research and search Summarization and transcription Writing (the big one) Art and music My great transition this year, as a programmer, was that once I accepted that AI can merge code without needing my review, I could let go. What this meant was that when AI writes English for me, I no longer need to review it before publishing. It can write English, and it writes it well. Okay, let me add this here

before I go too far: /s . I read this blog post yesterday, and I’m always baffled to hear technical people write these words : Writing code is solved. As a software engineer who uses AI, I feel like I must be holding it wrong. I’ve found a correlation between the number of lines of code written and the number of bugs found. Whether a person or a model generate...

5. Why are we all worked up about atomicity when applying hot-patches if we can just suspend all the threads?
Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Fri, 06 Nov 2026 15:00:00 +0000
Link: https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20261106-00/?p=112838/
Suspending all the threads stops the threads that are there now, those are not the only possible sources of change. The post Why are we all worked up about atomicity when applying hot-patches if we can just suspend all the threads? appeared first on The Old New Thing .

6. ? Touch and Glow
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-11-06T19:50:46Z
Link: https://daringfireball.net/2026/11/touch_and_glow
Apple?s ?Pro and Tell? event in Los Angeles, the new MacBook Pros with PROLED XDR displays, and the state of the Macintosh platform.

7. Apple Support: ?About the Illuminated Apple Logo on MacBook Pro With PROLED XDR Display?
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-11-06T15:03:51Z
Link: https://support.apple.com/en-us/149248
Apple Support: To make the Apple logo dark in all lighting conditions, you can turn off its illumination using Terminal, which is in the Utilities folder of your Applications folder. You can also use Spotlight to find and open it. Type or paste this command in Terminal, then press Return: sudo defaults write com.apple.CoreBrightness LEBacklightMode -int 0 [...] To turn logo illumination on again, enter this command in Terminal: sudo defaults delete com.apple.CoreBrightness LEBacklightMode Apple might make this a GUI setting, but if I were them, I?d keep it this way. Make the people without fun in their souls use the Terminal command. (Keeping it as a defaults setting also helps emphasize that you save no meaningful battery life by turning it off. If this gets exposed as a GUI preference, I could see it spreading as a dumb-ass ?pro tip? to turn it off to save battery life, like the unshakeable utterly wrongheaded belief millions hold that they should religiously force-quit apps on iOS, when in fact doing so chews up more energy when the apps get relaunched from a cold start.) ?

8. The President is Coping Well
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-11-06T15:00:22Z
Link: https://www.wsj.com/politics/policy/trump-signs-proclamation-he-says-will-protect-oval-office-from-major-changes-93f3285b
The WSJ, ?Trump Signs Proclamation He Says Will Protect Oval Office From Major Changes?: President Trump signed a proclamation Thursday that he said would designate the White House?s Oval Office and Cabinet Room as landmarks to prevent future presidents from making major changes to them. ?They won?t be able to be taken down, destroyed, touched or anything else,? Trump told reporters. ?It?s called, actually, a national monument. It?s a federal landmark, and when completed and when we get the documentation fully done, legally binding, it?ll make it impossible for anybody ever to destroy this incredible space.? Oh, buddy, every last bit of that pyrite cack will be pried off the walls and in a dumpster by mid-morning on 20 January 2029. You know that scene in Pulp Fiction where John Travolta?s Vincent Vega tells his drug dealer (Eric Stoltz) about his vintage Chevy Malibu getting keyed? ?Boy I wish I could?ve caught him doing it. I?d have given anything to catch that asshole doing it. It would have been worth him doing it, just so I could?ve caught him. What?s more chickenshit than fucking with a man?s automobile?? I sort of feel that way about Trump and the next two years. ?

9. Static site generators are weird

Source: Evan Hahn (dot com) | Published: Fri, 06 Nov 2026 17:00:00 +0000
Link: https://evanhahn.com/static-site-generators-are-weird/
I love static sites. Pre-rendered files are usually faster, lower maintenance, easier to secure, and more. Static site generators let you create these sites much more easily, which is fabulous. But I believe most static site generators are weird. SSGs like Jekyll , Gatsby , and Hugo require you to learn their special way of doing things. You have to answer questions like: How do you write HTML templates? How do you manage CSS and JavaScript? How do you deal with images and videos? How do you manage routing? How do you generate RSS feeds? How do you do unusual things, like one-off pages or redirects? You have to understand many of these in order to build a production-ready site, and every SSG is a different world. For example, my blog (which you?re reading right now!) has used Jekyll, Gatsby, and Hugo. For each one, I?ve had to learn its templating system, its asset system, its RSS feed system, and much more. Each project is thoughtfully designed, but totally its own thing. That?s not to mention the majority of SSGs, which are custom-made for one website. These projects tend to overflow with personality?rare programming languages, jagged feature sets, and flowery READMEs are on fin...

10. Weekend at Bernie?s II
Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-11-06T10:00:00+00:00
Link: https://nesbitt.io/2026/11/06/weekend-at-bernies-ii.html
Six months after Weekend at Bernie?s , 421 of the critical repos that were dead, dormant or unknown in May are active again. In the 1993 sequel , Bernie is brought back by a voodoo ceremony that goes slightly wrong, and the result is a corpse that moves whenever it hears music. In nearly a quarter of the revived repos the music shows up in the commit history as a coding agent, with most of those commits made by the repo?s own top committer. In the previous post I sorted the repos behind the ecosyste.ms critical packages into four buckets, and a follow-up went through the ways a project ends up dead : Active: regular non-bot commits to the default branch, or a release, in the past year. Dormant: little or no development, but someone with write access has closed an issue, merged a PR or pushed a commit in the past year. Dead: archived, or with issues and PRs filed in the past year and no response from anyone with write access. Unknown: no issues, PRs or activity in the past year, so responsiveness hasn?t been tested. In the previous post I predicted that AI-assisted vulnerability discovery was about to test the quiet ones: ?The first security report against any of them will be that...

11. A video game which caused real world violence
Source: Terence Eden?s Blog | Published: Fri, 06 Nov 2026 12:34:34 +0000
Link: https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/11/a-video-game-which-caused-real-world-violence/
There has been a dramatic fall in the amount of interpersonal violence in most countries. I don’t want to go too Freakanomics and, obviously, correlation is not causation but perhaps video games have a role to play in this? A teenager being cooped up in their room means less exposure to situations where hormonal impertinence is likely to cause a violent reaction. Shouting and screaming at people ?

12. How Do Building Codes Affect the Price of Housing?
Source: Construction Physics | Published: Fri, 06 Nov 2026 13:01:35 GMT
Link: https://www.construction-physics.com/p/how-do-building-codes-affect-the
A great deal of effort has gone into understanding the regulatory burden on housing construction, and the extent to which it contributes to high housing prices.

13. Premium: Fault Lines
Source: Ed Zitron’s Where’s Your Ed At | Published: Fri, 06 Nov 2026 16:44:41 GMT
Link: https://www.wheresyoured.at/premium-fault-lines/
I?ve generally avoided politics here and the few times that I have done so I?ve received a few pissy emails, but Tuesday night was a wonderful, abundant font of hope in what has been an unspeakably grim two years. We have felt land-locked in

14. Deus Ex
Source: The Digital Antiquarian | Published: Fri, 06 Nov 2026 15:34:48 +0000
Link: https://www.filfre.net/2026/11/deus-ex/
This article tells part of the story of Warren Spector. A slight shift of focus, and the future could still turn out like Deus Ex after all? ? Deus Ex lead writer Sheldon Pacotti, speaking in 2014 The reviews that greeted Ion Storm?s Deus Ex upon its release in June of 2000 ranged along a continuum [?]